# DESIGNING GRAPHICS:
## THE ESSENTIALS

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# THE ESSENTIALS…

- Types of graphical materials
- Considerations in design
    1. Purpose
    2. Audience
    3. Colour
    4. Text
    5. Use of images
    6. Positioning of images
    7. Layout
- Parts/Content
    1. Call for attention
    2. Developing interest
    3. Call for action


You
Tube

# CONSIDERATIONS IN DESIGN: AN OVERVIEW

# 1. PURPOSE…

- Purpose – promotional or informational?
- Promotional – aim to persuade
- Informational – aim to share facts/figures
- When designing, have an apparent vision of where you want to go with it (target) and a message that will be easy for your audience to make out.
- Software to use:
  - Non-professional use: Powerpoint/Publisher/Word
  - Professional use: Adobe Illustrator  (Design can be scaled up or down in terms of size/pixel and colour tone).

# 2. DEFINE AUDIENCE…

- Who are you designing for and what will they want to see?
- Need to establish an emotional connection with audience. Put yourself in the shoes of your target audience.
- Define audience by age group, location and social-economic/geographical status.
- E.g. 1: certain colours and images will have different impact (for children colourful images and cartoons are appropriate; but for their parents…?)
- E.g. 2: retail of a higher end product/service, your brochure will have different needs – for example, you may want to print it on luxury paper.

# 3. DEFINE BRAND…

- What kind of organisational/corporate image does an organisation carry?
- E.g. Designing graphics for Starbucks versus a Mamak stall/eatery - How do you define your brand through colour theme/use of logo?

# 3. COLOUR… (1)

- Play this quiz – Which colour defines you/your personality?
- Go to Spectrum (link given under Week 8) http://www.playbuzz.com/benjaminbirely10/what-color-is-your-personality
- Go to Google Search – type in ‘playbuzz’, ‘what colour is your personality’

# 3. COLOUR… (2)

- Colour  should be unique, appropriate and customer-orientated.
- Ties in with your corporate or brand colour (e.g. Think of Coca Cola, tech company Apple)
- Don’t go overboard. Make sure you don’t have colours that will compete for the attention of your audience.
- Consider culture: Different cultures could give a different interpretation / understanding of a colour
- E.g. Black (Western versus Chinese)
- Colour can also have a psychological/emotional impact - how we feel (psychology of colours).

# The *psychology* of colours






**DISCUSSION:**
Think about the corporate colours of Malaysian airline companies:

a) Malaysia Airline
b) Air Asia
c) Malindo Air
d) Fireflyz

What does each corporate colour say about the image of the company?

# 3.COLOUR…(3)

- Every colour carries a different response
- Can be categorized as:

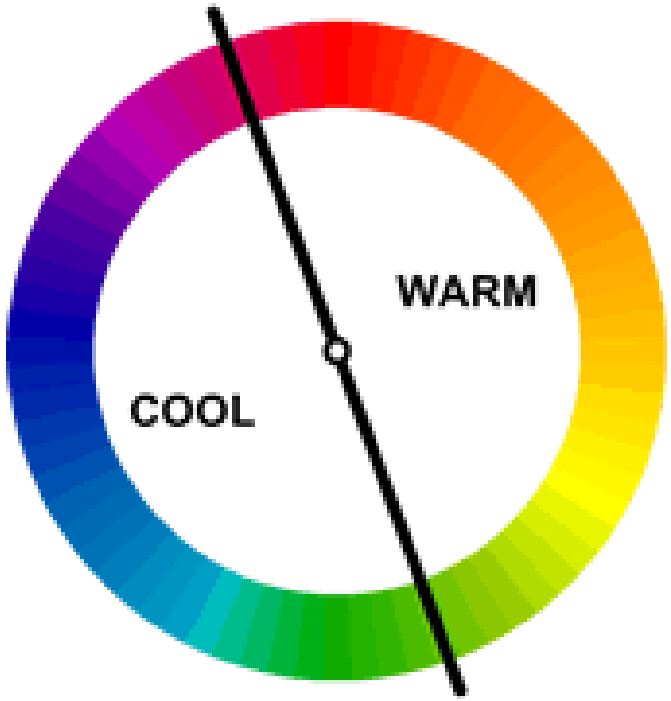
## Warm and cool colors

The color circle can be divided into warm and cool colors.

**Warm colors** are vivid and energetic, and tend to advance in space.

**Cool colors** give an impression of calm, and create a soothing impression.

White, black and gray are considered to be neutral.



# DISCUSSION…

- In groups, discuss what each colour mean and where/how it is used. (general)

1. Warm colours: Red, orange, yellow, pink
2. Cool colours: Blue, purple, brown
3. Neutral colours: Black, white, grey



# WARM COLOURS (1)

- **Red:** Associated with an increased heart rate, emotions including danger, passion, energy and aggression. Cover many spectrums but can often dominate a page or poster - be cautious when using it. Red is an extremely popular colour to promote special offers or sales as it grabs our attention. Red is a popular colour in the automotive, food and technology industries but tends to be unpopular for clothing, energy and finance.

- **Orange:** Creates a sense of energy and when we think of orange we often think of heat and warmth. Orange has the brightness of yellow and energy of red making orange a fun and exciting colour to use. Popular in technology and health industries but unpopular with clothing, energy, transport and finance.

# WARM COLOURS (2)

- **Yellow:** When it comes to print, yellow is one colour that can be hard to work with especially when used with white. It does however create a sense of optimism as we can often think of the sun. Yellow can work really well when used with red, especially when promoting sales and offers as it catches the eye. Popular in food, energy and household industries but not much used in the travel and technology sectors.

- **Pink:** Strong feminine association, often used to market to women and young girls. Very calming colour that evokes a sense of romance. Just think of hearts and roses the colour pink comes to mind. Very powerful tool in the beauty and clothing industries, particularly among young women. More recently, popular in the travel and automotive industry.

# COOL COLOURS (1)

- **Blue:** One of the most popular colours among brands, particularly in print. If you think of some of the biggest global brands, IBM, Facebook, Intel, Samsung, HP and Nivea, they all use blue throughout their print material. Blue is a very calming colour; often associated with the sky and the sea. It also evokes a sense of trust and security. Popular in the financial and corporate industry along with the technology sector.

- **Green:** Often seen as a fresh and healthy colour that also carries wealthy associations. Easy colour for the human eye and mind to process; relaxing to look at. Extremely popular in the health industry and pharmacies in particular. Less popular in the airline industry though other than Aie Lingus (Irish national carrier).

# COOL COLOURS (2)

- **Purple:** Often associated with elegance but like blue it has soothing and calming influences. Also creates a sense of nostalgia but is a very powerful colour and one that can add real elegance to your printing needs. Purple is popular in the health and beauty industry;  unpopular with energy and agricultural organisations.

- **Brown:**  May not be the most popular or glamorous of colours when it comes to meeting your print requirements but one thing brown does really well is to create a natural connection. Brown evokes a connection with earth and is seen as an extremely durable colour; often used in the clothing and agricultural sectors. Be cautious when using brown as it is often associated with dirt and lack of cleanliness.

# NEUTRAL COLOURS

- **White:** One of the most popular colours to work with in print. Works with almost every colour but avoid using light shades of yellow and orange with white (low colour contrast – unclear). Represents purity and cleanliness. Think of the fashion industry and wedding gowns, the health industry and lab jackets and you instantly think of white. More recently white has become a popular colour in the automotive and technology industries.

- **Black:** Sophisticated colour; often associated with wealth and power and is used to promote luxury products. Often used as the primary colour in posters for goods like luxury cars, clothing and jewellery. Black is less popular when it comes to promoting areas like health care and energy.

# WHITE SPACE

- White space is vital in print materials
- Synonymous with readability
- Works well with darker colours – high colour contrast (clearer)

# 4. TEXT…

- Role of text extremely important so that audience can understand your message
- Font chosen must be easy to read up close and also from a distance
- Font type
  - SERIF (e.g. Times New Roman) – formal but traditional
  - SAN SERIF (e.g. Arial/Calibri) – formal modern
- Recommendation – adopt a 'less is more' approach as audience likely to have a short period of time to take in your message.
- Consider bullet points/tables
- Ensure it is printed on a legible background. Avoid text running throughout an image and using light coloured text on a light background (low colour contrast – unclear).

# 5. USE OF IMAGES…

- Like colour, images can often be a great way of making an impact with posters and the two often go hand in hand.
- Ensure image is of the highest quality and saved as 300dpi (minimum).
- Low quality images (e.g. 72dpi) are great for a computer screen and can look good on a website but when they are increased in size to be used in a poster or billboard, they can appear pixelated and lacking in quality.

# 6.POSITIONING OF IMAGES…

- If your infographic is connected to text, make this clear in the placement of the graphic.
- If a diagram is particularly complex or important, may need its own page or even spread.
- If it is going across a spread or a fold, consider where the fold or inner spine will fall and keep this area clear of important text.

# 7. **LAYOUT…**

- See the 6 panels of a brochure in Chapter/Project 11 of textbook
- See layout of a flyer on Spectrum
- See layout/structure of website/social media in Chapter/Project 12 of textbook
- Consider
  - headings to divide different sections/disgestible chunks
  - Interactiveness/user-friendliness (online mode)

# CONTENT OF GRAPHICAL MATERIALS

# 1. CALL FOR ATTENTION

- Catch the attention of the reader through statements/graphics
- Statement: problem description/reader benefit/amazing fact/testimonial/reference to current event
- Graphics: Play with (bold/bright) colours and (large) sizes of
- Don’t be afraid to keep it simple, as this could be equally effective

# 2. DEVELOPING INTEREST…

- Describe the product/service/event/idea
- Show how reader benefits/related to reader concerns
- Develop information clearly, vividly and persuasively

# 3. CALL FOR ACTION:

- Instruct reader to act (e.g. Call now…/Register now…)
- Provide additional information (if necessary)
- Inform where to get/find out more information
- How:
  - Providing an email address, a website or using social media icons to direct your reader.
  - Most popular form of call for action – QR Codes. Use these to give your customer instant and accessible information.

# CONCLUSION

When designing graphical material for your project, think about:

1. **Content** - Fulfils features of call for attention, develop interest & call for action. Clearly states the purpose of the material

2. **Design**: Attractive in terms of layout, neatness, aesthetic value and creativity/uniqueness; consider balance when positioning texts and images. Online mode – interactiveness & userfriendliness

3. **Language (Textual or Visual):** Communicates the content very clearly; attracts/ holds attention of readers and conveys purpose